



A black and white photograph of a horse race. A large crowd of spectators is gathered behind a wooden fence, watching the race. Several horses are running on the track, and one horse is lying down in the foreground.

Year	World Price of Rubber (\$/ton)
1840	~50
1870	~180
1911	~520

Technological innovations, especially the tires used on the increasingly popular motorcar, fueled a rise in the use—and price—of rubber.

In Europe, **Marie Curie** (1867–1934), a Polish-born French scientist, won her second **Nobel Prize**, this time in chemistry for her work on **radioactivity**. She and her husband, Pierre (1859–1906), had been the recipients of the 1903 Nobel Prize for Physics.

In 1911, the world **price of rubber** was beginning to soar, fueled by its use in **new technologies**, especially in the production of automobile tires. Rubber came from the sap of trees that grew in the forests of Brazil, Southeast Asia, and West Africa.

In March 1912, **Morocco** was established as a French **protectorate** under the **Treaty of Fez**. The year before the new sultan **Abd al-Hafiz** (c.1875–1937), besieged in his palace, had asked the French to help him suppress internal dissent.

THE TREATY OF LONDON OF 1913 OFFICIALLY SIGNALLED THE END of the First Balkan War. However, the Balkan League—Serbia, Bulgaria, Montenegro, and Greece—that had challenged the Ottoman Empire soon began to disintegrate. Bulgaria attacked Serbia in June because of a disagreement over the **division of Macedonia**, although the fighting ended a couple of months later with a **Serbian–Greek alliance**. Greece and Serbia would receive most of Macedonia with Bulgaria



By the early 20th century, the fight for women to be given the vote had gained momentum all over the world. Australia had followed New Zealand (see 1893) by giving women suffrage in 1902. In northern Europe, Finland had given women the right to vote in 1906, while Norway followed in 1913. While, women suffragists in Britain would have to wait until after World War I, countries such as Russia and the US (see above—states with full suffrage are gold) also began to peel back voting restrictions around this time.

In Britain, the **suffragist battle** to give women the right to vote (see panel, left) took a violent turn as campaigner **Emily Davison** (1872–1913) threw herself in front of King George V's horse during the Epsom Derby in June. The horse, Anmer, struck Davison's chest and she was knocked down and remained unconscious for four days, until she died of her injuries on June 8. It remains unclear if her intention was to commit suicide. A public funeral was held for her in London on 14 June.

By 1913, **Henry Ford** (1863–1947), the head of the US Ford Motor Company, which he set up in 1903, had sold nearly **250,000 Model T cars**. Although other companies were making cars, they were far too expensive for average consumers. Ford wanted to make them more affordable so he began production of the basic **Model T**. He also developed new and more efficient production techniques through the use of



An illustration from Le Petit Journal depicts the murder of Nazim Pasha, Ottoman minister of war, during the First Balkan War.

moving **assembly lines** that he had installed in his Michigan factory. This improvement meant that a completed chassis (car body) could be made in just over an hour and a half, while his competitors took hours longer.

**“ HISTORY IS
MORE OR LESS
BUNK. IT’S
TRADITION. ”**

Henry Ford, US industrialist,
in an interview in the *Chicago Tribune*, May 25, 1916

December 29 Sun Yat-sen becomes first president of the Chinese Republic

December 14 Roald Amundsen's expedition reaches the South Pole

December 19 Russia declares its independence

December 31 India gains independence



A horizontal timeline for the year 1907. The timeline is a horizontal line with four circular markers. Above the line, from left to right, are the following events:

- January 8** African National Congress formed in South Africa
- March 30** French and Spanish establish protectorates in Morocco under Treaty of Fez
- October 8** First Balkan War begins

 Below the line, from left to right, are the following events:

- April 14** Luxury cruise liner **RMS Titanic** sinks on its maiden voyage

February 22 Mexican President Francisco Madero assassinated (b. 1873)

May 30 Treaty of London ends First Balkan

June 4 British suffragette Emily Davison trampled by King George V's horse at the Epsom Derby

June 18 Arab Congress meets to discuss reforms under the Ottoman Empire

September 1918 Serb troops enter Belgrade

A horizontal timeline with a green line. Two points are marked with black dots. From the first dot, a line goes up to a circle, then diagonally down to the text: **June 29 Second Balkan War begins**. From the second dot, a line goes up to a circle, then diagonally down to the text: **September 29 Peace treaty signed between Ottoman Empire and kingdom of Bulgaria**.

October 10
Panama canal
completed

December 1 Ford
Motor Company
introduces moving
assembly belts into
car factories